Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report on

Ty Galan

Porth

Date Inspection Completed

15 April 2024 15/04/2024

Welsh Government © Crown copyright 2024.
You may use and re-use the information featured in this publication (not including logos) free of charge in any format or medium, under the terms of the Open Government License. You can view the Open Government License, on the National Archives website or you can write to the Information Policy Team, The National Archives, Kew, London TW9 4DU, or email: psi@nationalarchives.gsi.gov.uk
You must reproduce our material accurately and not use it in a misleading context.

About Ty Galan

Type of care provided	Care Home Service Children's Home
Registered Provider	Orbis Education and Care Limited
Registered places	3
Language of the service	English
Previous Care Inspectorate Wales inspection	28 September 2022 [Manual Insert]
Does this service promote Welsh language and culture?	This service does not provide an 'Active Offer' of the Welsh language and does not demonstrate a significant effort to promoting the use of the Welsh language and culture.

Summary

Children are settled and content in their comfortable, homely home. They have positive, trusting relationships with trained, consistent care staff and are achieving positive well-being outcomes.

A rights-based approach is evident at the service and children are respected and listened to.

Documentation and guidance for care staff is detailed and care staff know children well and can anticipate their needs. Care staff's value base is one of empathy and empowerment for children to achieve to their potential and to be part of the community.

There is a positive culture at the service and care staff feel supported and valued.

The home is in a good state of repair; it is homely, child-friendly and has the space and facilities children need.

Sound quality assurance systems are enabling the service to improve and develop and demonstrate the responsible individual (RI) is fulfilling their regulatory role.

Well-being

Children express themselves and are listened to. Each week children are consulted in a session called “My Voice”, where their views are elicited and recorded. These sessions are used to explore topics such as the décor of their rooms, the outcomes they wish to achieve and their feelings about care staff and being safe. Children make daily choices about their clothes, food and activities and they communicate their wishes informally. Care staff are responsive but ensure suitable boundaries are maintained. Children are consulted as part of the service’s quality assurance processes and they can influence the service they receive.

Care staff support children to achieve good health and education outcomes. There is a focus on healthy eating and exercise at a sensitive pace. Some children are eating healthily and are readily taking exercise, while others are gradually engaging in creative approaches to new foods and are taking up opportunities to go outdoors for walks. Care staff know how best to support children’s emotional stability and how to respond if they do become anxious. Children are attending school regularly and are making good progress. They benefit from the partnership work between the home and their schools in addressing their complex needs.

Care staff ensure children are safeguarded. Children are supported by suitably trained and knowledgeable care staff and a manager who ensures safeguarding is a regular topic for discussion at various staff forums. Some children have advocates and care staff support children to see their families and people who are important to them regularly. Applications for deprivation of liberty orders are in place for some children and others have their own fob access to the front door.

Children like their comfortable, homely home. Following a difficult transition for some children, they are settling well and now say: *“Ty Galan is my home”.* The home is colourful, child-friendly and well-furnished and offers the space needed for the children to feel comfortable and calm. It is safe and secure and provides facilities for children to develop independence skills.

Care and Support

Children are assured care staff read and understand their regularly reviewed personal plans so they can safely care for them and support them to achieve their well-being outcomes. Children's personal plans contain detailed guidance for care staff about their daily routines, likes/dislikes, health and the support they need when they are anxious and unsettled. Risk assessments contain comprehensive information and guidance which care staff follow to keep children safe. Care staff we spoke to showed they were familiar with how best to support and respond to children's needs. We saw clear evidence of children achieving their personal outcomes such as staying in a hotel, visiting a theme park and going bowling together.

Motivated, committed care staff are meeting children's communication needs which enables children to build positive, trusting relationships with them. Care staff talk about children with affection and warmth and they use a range of communication tools to promote children's engagement and understanding, which ensures they are able to make contributions and choices. They are familiar with the meaning of children's verbal responses and respond appropriately to ensure children receive the right care at the time they need it. Children are relaxed around care staff and humour is used to good effect.

Care staff support children to be healthy as they can be and to engage in education. Children are registered with primary health services and are prepared and supported by care staff to attend appointments with these and more specialist health professionals. There is evidence of joint work with the service's clinical staff which results in successful health outcomes. Some children's diets are healthy and they are supported to achieve a more healthy weight while creative partnership work with schools is supporting the introduction of different foods to other children's self-limiting diets. Children are engaging in exercise at a pace which suits their needs; they are doing things like swimming, trampolining and walking and they also enjoy other fun activities such as bowling. Some children initially struggled with the transition to school, however, following patient support and clear boundaries they are now attending regularly. Children are making good progress and there are positive relationships between the schools and the home.

Suitable safeguarding practices means children are safe and protected. Trained care staff have access to a suitable safeguarding policy, they know their safeguarding duties and safeguarding is a regular topic at team meetings and supervisions. Incident reports show children are supported in the least restrictive manner; debriefs are held with care staff when needed and children are offered sensitively timed, informal debriefs. Important information about expressing a concern or making a complaint is shared with children in suitable formats.

Children safely receive their medication. Medication administration charts show care staff are following the service provider's medication policy and they are recording the reasons for administering any PRN (as needed) medication. Care staff use their knowledge of children to help them tolerate the application of topical medication.

Environment

The environment is suitable and is meeting children's needs. The home is well furnished, comfortable and homely. Colourful pictures reflecting children's interests are displayed around it along with pictures of children enjoying activities which promotes a sense of belonging. Children's bedrooms are clean and decorated according to children's choices and personal interests. The provision of two living rooms means children have the space they need to self- regulate.

The kitchen contains suitable facilities and is clean and well-stocked. Some children plan their menu each week which is displayed on the wall and both children are taking part in preparing food. Children are helping with laundry tasks and some manage the washing of their clothes independently. They maintain good personal hygiene in a modern, clean bathroom which contains their labelled basket of toiletries and colour coded towels.

The service provider ensures the home is as safe and secure as possible. We were asked to show our identification and sign in on arrival and the visitors' book showed people are regularly signing in and out as required. Care staff undertake regular health and safety and fire safety checks and both children and care staff participate in regular fire drills. Cleaning materials and medication are stored in locked cupboards; medication is clearly dated on opening and there are daily temperature recordings of the medicine cabinet. The repair log shows repairs are attended to in a timely manner and the home is in a good state of repair.

The garden contains a small, paved area and has sufficient space for children to play ball games and to sit outside. Steps lead to an upper platform where there is a swing chair and plant pots and children are encouraged to take part in seasonal gardening activities to enhance the outdoor area. Children can access the safe rear garden and some have a fob for the locked front door, however, they tend to rely on care staff to open it.

Leadership and Management

The service provider gathers a range of information to ensure they are able to meet children's needs. Referral documents, local authority care plans and contributions from other professionals and stake holders are used to inform the service provider's admission processes and decisions for children to come and live at the home. Impact assessments are carried out and partnership work with other agencies supports children's settling in period at the home. Provider assessments are completed and are regularly updated in relation to children's changing needs.

The service provider ensures children and their representatives have the information they need about the service. The statement of purpose is regularly updated; it includes recent changes in legislation and it reflects the service we saw at inspection. Suitably formatted guides to the service are shared with children which include information about how to make a complaint or communicate something worrying them.

There are a sufficient number of trained, experienced care staff to meet children's needs and keep them safe. Aside from two new starters, children are cared for by a consistent team of care staff, some of whom are qualified while others are completing the required qualification for their role; all are registered with Social Care Wales. Rotas show there are enough care staff each day with no use of agency staff.

Care staff are supported to fulfil their role. All care staff are trained in the core areas of safeguarding, behaviour management, first aid and fire safety and they also undertake training on a range of topics relevant to their role. They receive regular supervision which has a balanced focus on their well-being and work. Regular team meetings provide opportunities to discuss children's needs and to consider developments in practice. Care staff told us they were a "*close, supportive team".* Feedback questionnaires from care staff indicate a positive team culture of motivated care staff, with statements such as:
"*Even after tough days I look forward to returning to Ty Galan and embracing the amazing opportunity to support and be a part of the young people's lives that I get to call work*."

"*The manager of the home is what makes the house work well. She goes above and beyond for all her staff team and young people".*

There are clear quality assurance systems which ensure improvements are made to the service children receive. The RI regularly visits the home to undertake a range of checks and they consult children, care staff and other stakeholders. The service provider carries out a range of audits and the manager responds promptly to the identified shortfalls in both the audits and regulatory visits. The quality of care reports present a detailed, rounded picture of the service, its achievements and challenges and areas for development. The RI has oversight of these reports and makes a considered view on its progress.

Summary of Non-Compliance	
Status	**What each means**
New	This non-compliance was identified at this inspection.
Reviewed	Compliance was reviewed at this inspection and was not achieved. The target date for compliance is in the future and will be tested at next inspection.
Not Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was not achieved.
Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was achieved.

We respond to non-compliance with regulations where poor outcomes for people, and / or risk to people's well-being are identified by issuing Priority Action Notice (s).

The provider must take immediate steps to address this and make improvements. Where providers fail to take priority action by the target date we may escalate the matter to an Improvement and Enforcement Panel.

Priority Action Notice(s)		
Regulation	Summary	Status
N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

Where we find non-compliance with regulations but no immediate or significant risk for people using the service is identified we highlight these as Areas for Improvement.

We expect the provider to take action to rectify this and we will follow this up at the next inspection. Where the provider has failed to make the necessary improvements we will escalate the matter by issuing a Priority Action Notice.

Area(s) for Improvement		
Regulation	Summary	Status

N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

Was this report helpful?

We want to hear your views and experiences of reading our inspection reports. This will help us understand whether our reports provide clear and valuable information to you.

To share your views on our reports please visit the following link to complete a short survey:

- Inspection report survey

If you wish to provide general feedback about a service, please visit our Feedback surveys page.

Date Published 08/05/2024